

SIGCHI Across Borders: Bringing Together the Local and Global

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ABSTRACT

This panel aims to invite perspectives from “global” and “local” actors within the Computer-Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW) community towards fostering a greater understanding of the support that SIGCHI infrastructures can provide for strengthening ties across various borders. Members of the SIGCHI Executive Committee will host a panel to identify challenges and opportunities in this regard, and invite all attendees of CSCW 2021 to participate, providing inputs and feedback.

CCS CONCEPTS

• **Human-centered computing** → **Human computer interaction (HCI)**; **Collaborative and social computing**.

KEYWORDS

SIGCHI; CSCW; Global; Local

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1 INTRODUCTION

In recent years, the membership of the Special Interest Group for Computer-Human Interaction (SIGCHI) of the Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) has become increasingly diverse and globally distributed [11]. Communities around the world have taken initiative to organize events to strengthen Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) and Computer-Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW) scholarship in their respective regions, often with support from the

SIGCHI Development Fund [7]. Despite such recent developments, North America and Europe still maintain a dominant presence at SIGCHI and its conferences. In other regions, SIGCHI’s presence is yet to be recognized and felt. Even within regions that are active, different countries are represented to varying degrees [3, 14].

As we recognize and celebrate the abundant diversity and *difference* across our events and initiatives, we also acknowledge that there is value in highlighting the *commonalities* amid the differences. Despite the currently inequitable participation [14], there is potential for individuals and groups to step beyond regional boundaries, and to align and collaborate within the fields of HCI and CSCW [2]. The SIGCHI Executive Committee (EC), in its current term (2021-2024), is committed to foregrounding and expanding on these commonalities, towards making our community more globally *and* locally connected. In line with this goal, we intend to make conversations around “common differences” [5] more commonplace across our conferences, so that we can best support communities across the world in participating actively and meaningfully, and more importantly, *on their terms*.

SIGCHI’s recent series of Equity Talks has highlighted that members of our global community have an interest in a wide range of HCI activities [1]. We have researchers, educators, designers, and practitioners in our midst [12], we have members solidly committed to activism in support of inclusive publication practices [13], we are increasingly embracing accessible and sustainable futures [4, 6, 9, 10, 12, 13, 15, 16]. More importantly, the attendance across these Equity Talks suggests that many of us may align on multiple dimensions, even when a few may be dominant in our interests.

In this panel, we plan to invite researchers, practitioners, designers, and educators from different regions, *pluriverses* if you will [8], to discuss how these separate communities can individually and collectively be better supported. We aim to identify common threads across borders: challenges and opportunities, research themes and topics of interest, and more generally, ideas for interaction and knowledge exchange. In addition, our discussion will identify ways of incentivizing sustained exchanges and partnerships across pluriverses to build new ones, going beyond geographical delimiters.

2 FORMAT

In this virtual panel, we will aim to go back and forth between the panelists and the audience, fostering as much community engagement as possible. There will be at least four EC members present,

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taking turns to moderate, note-take, and manage a collaborative, live document.

We will begin with the panelists presenting a challenge to the audience, based on their experiences (across sectors) in contending with local/global tensions (15 mins). We will do breakout sessions for 20 minutes, where each session will be dedicated to one of the challenges. After this brief sense-making and brainstorming session, we will bring everyone back into one room, taking turns to listen to each breakout (20 mins). Notes will be maintained throughout in our collaborative document. Over the remaining time, our goal will be to identify challenges and opportunities towards sensitizing the CSCW audience. One goal is to establish new avenues for collaboration and initiatives that may help bring people together. There are often common elements that cut across geography, which may work as a conduit for the creation of new links within the community. These connections can work as a catalyst to establish new ties.

3 PARTICIPANTS

Existing structures tend to organize and group people following geography (e.g., chapters, regional committees, local events, etc.), and our aim is to bring together some of the voices that have actively been contributing towards strengthening the SIGCHI and CSCW communities at various global and local levels. We look to the broader CSCW community to contribute their knowledge of challenges towards the discussion, generating novel ideas for SIGCHI initiatives.

Melissa Densmore (*participant*) is an associate professor in the department of Computer Science at the University of Cape Town in South Africa, where she directs the HCI Lab and coordinates the South African branch of the Hasso-Plattner Institute Research School. Her research interests are in human computer interaction for development (HCI4D), co-design for mothers, and community-based digital content creation and collaboration. She serves on the SIGCHI Research Ethics committee and is the founding chair of ProteaCHI, the ACM SIGCHI chapter in South Africa.

Maristella Matera (*participant*) is an associate professor at Politecnico di Milano, Italy. Her research focuses on models, methods and tools for the design of interactive systems, with emphasis on the End-User Development of human-centric systems in different domains. She is the author of four books and more than 200 publications, and has served as an organizer and program-committee member in several international conferences in the fields of HCI, End-User Development, Model-driven/Web Engineering. She currently chairs SIGCHI Italy, the Italian Chapter of ACM SIGCHI, where she works on initiatives to promote HCI in the country and strengthen the liaisons with other HCI and SIGCHI communities at the international level.

Pushpendra Singh (*participant*) Pushpendra is a professor in the Dept. of Computer Science and Engineering and Dept. of Human-Centered Design at IIIT-Delhi. His research lies at the intersection of mobile computing and HCI with a focus on technologies for low-resource settings, especially in the context of Public Health.

Christian Sturm (*participant*) is professor for interdisciplinary informatics at the Hamm-Lippstadt University of Applied Sciences in Germany. His academic background includes computer science, cognitive psychology, and cultural anthropology. He has worked

for several years in academia and industry in Mexico, Spain, and Egypt and taught computer science in China. His research includes experience research and design, cross-cultural interactions, and entrepreneurship.

Marisol Wong-Villacrés (*participant*) is an associate professor at Escuela Superior Politécnica del Litoral in Ecuador. Her research explores how cultural and learning science theories can inform an assets-based participatory design of technologies that support historically marginalized groups, such as immigrant parents from developing regions, in pursuing sustainable, emancipatory transformations. She is currently a member of the ACM SIGCHI Latin American Committee, where she works on initiatives that highlight the lessons that CSCW and HCI research can draw from Latin America. She also participates as Associate Chair, author, and reviewer at the CSCW conference.

Adriana S. Vivacqua (*moderator + participant*) is an associate professor at the Institute of Computing at the Federal University of Rio de Janeiro (UFRJ), Brazil. She has been conducting research on HCI and CSCW for the past 15 years, with an emphasis on looking at local problems (current interests focus on data literacy and informal interactions). She chairs the SIGCHI Latin America Committee and serves on ACM GROUP's Steering Committee. She is currently SIGCHI Vice-President at Large, alongside Naomi Yamashita.

Naomi Yamashita (*moderator + participant*) is a primary researcher at NTT Labs and also an adjunct professor at Kyoto University. Her research interests focus on designing technologies for diversity and inclusion in various contexts (e.g., global collaboration and mental healthcare). She currently serves on the editorial advisory board of JCSCW, papers co-chair for CSCW 2022, and has served on the Steering Committee of CSCW (2012-2015). She is also the Vice-Chair of the ACM SIGCHI Japan Chapter and SIGCHI Vice-President at Large with Adriana S. Vivacqua.

Shaowen Bardzell (*moderator*) is professor of information sciences and technology at the Pennsylvania State University's College of Information Sciences and Technology. Her research explores the contributions of design, feminism, and social science to support technology's role in social change. She is also the Executive Vice-President on the SIGCHI Executive Committee.

Neha Kumar (*moderator*) is an associate professor at the Georgia Institute of Technology, where she conducts research at the intersection of HCI and Global Development (or HCI4D). She also serves as the SIGCHI president at present (2021-2024), where she looks forward to foregrounding and strengthening local and global ties across the SIGCHI community.

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